Monopoly's inventor got $500.

> The man who sold it died a millionaire.

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Lizzie Magie, a Maryland stenographer, patents The Landlord's Game.

1904

patent granted for The Landlord's Game

Built to show how landlords get rich and everyone else pays.

> Based on economist Henry George's ideas.

Charles Darrow learns the game from an acquaintance and claims it as his own.

🎲

Homemade boards

🤝

Passed hand to hand

✍️

Claimed by Darrow

Parker Brothers buys Monopoly from Darrow: $7,000 up front.

$7,000

initial payment to Darrow, plus royalties

Then they buy Magie's patent. One time. $500.

DARROW

Died a millionaire

MAGIE

$500 was the most she made

Same game. Two very different deals.

- **1904** Patent
- **1933** Darrow
- **1935** Sold
- **1948** Magie dies

A game built to warn about monopolies became the one that teaches you to win one.

> Source: Mary Pilon, The Monopolists (2015).

YOUR RULE

Own the upside, not just the idea.

1. Put your name on your work, in writing
2. Ask for ongoing terms, not just a one-off fee
3. Know what your idea earns for others

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